LLM DAY BANGALORE

Attention Is the New Moat.

Why the only defensible advantage left is being in someone's head, before they ever go looking.

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A STORY · 2022

The rocket ship that everyone wanted in on.

Jasper AI, the hottest writing tool on the planet.

$1.5B

Series A valuation

100K+

Paying customers

$120M

ARR at peak

Strong team. Real revenue. Serious investors. By every measure, a rocket ship.

THEN EVERYTHING CHANGED

Then ChatGPT launched. For free.

REVENUE

$120M ↘

before

$55M

MONTHLY TRAFFIC

8.7M ↘

before

6.1M

VALUATION

$1.5B ↘

before

Cratered

Within two months. Both co-founders stepped down.

THE REAL CAUSE

It wasn't competition.

It wasn't bad code.

It wasn't the wrong hire.

It was STRUCTURAL.

Their entire reason to exist was access to a model. The moment that model became free, the reason to choose Jasper evaporated.

ACT ONE

The moat you think you have is dissolving.

Falling model costs and a flood of look-alike products mean the technical advantage is collapsing in real time.

300x

Price collapse in 3 years

GPT-4: $30 to $0.10 per million tokens

70,000+

AI startups globally

All racing for the same attention

THE NUMBER THAT SHOULD STOP EVERY FOUNDER

42%

of failed AI startups didn't fail on product, market, or money. They launched something nobody knew existed.

Not the product didn't work. Not wrong market. Not out of money. **Nobody knew it existed.**

CASE STUDY · HUMANE AI PIN

Pedigree and funding could not buy back a lost narrative.

$241M raised · Ex-Apple designers · Launched April 2024

10K

UNITS SOLD

Target was 100,000

$116M

ACQUISITION

Less than half of funds raised

Feb '25

SHUT DOWN

Product killed permanently

> *By the time most people heard about the AI Pin, they already had a fixed idea of what it was. The narrative was set before the product had a chance.*

ACT TWO

II

The decision is made before the search begins.

By the time a buyer starts researching, the shortlist is already written. The real battle happens earlier.

WHERE BUYERS ACTUALLY DECIDE

Buyers pick from a list they wrote before they ever searched.

90%

choose a vendor from their day-one list, brands known before research began

95%

buy a brand they were already aware of

80%

buy the exact brand they expected to

In software specifically · Harvard Business Review. *The decision is made weeks before the search begins.*

THE MATH THAT BREAKS MOST MARKETING

Most budgets chase the 5% already shopping.

5%
buying now

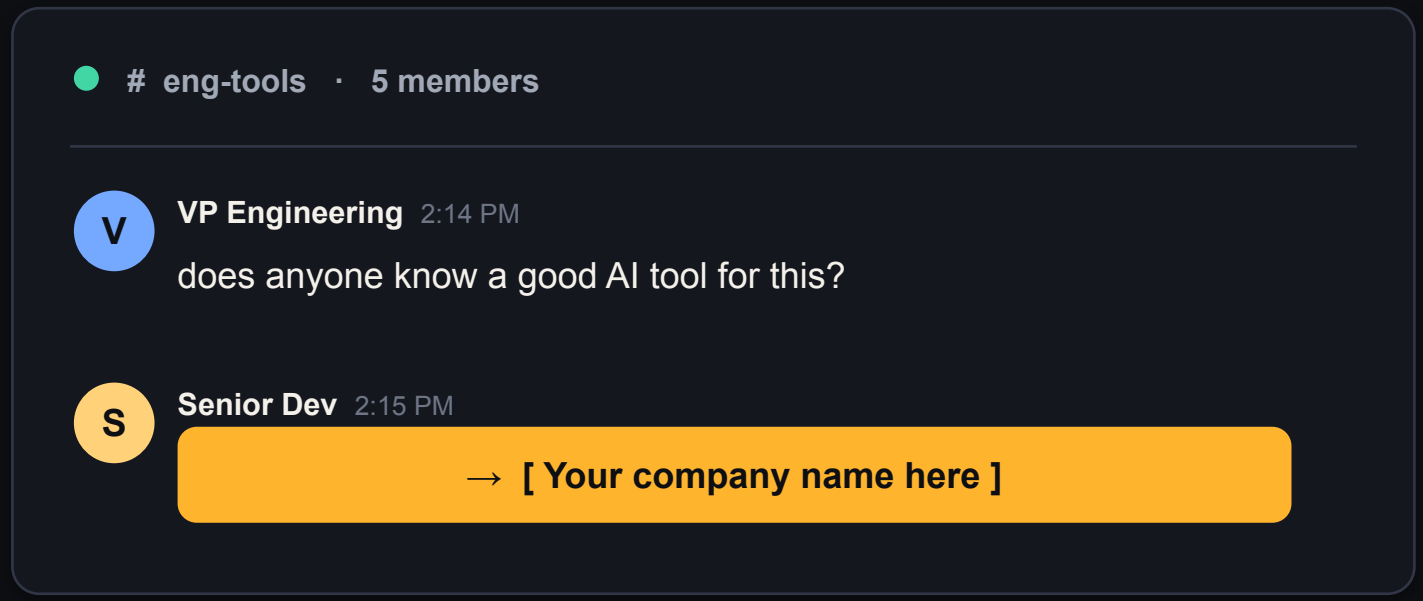
95%
will buy eventually, ignored by most

80% of marketing budgets fight over this sliver.

81% of buyers have already decided who they will buy from before they ever enter the market.

RIGHT NOW. SOMEWHERE.

This is the conversation that actually decides it.



84%

of content sharing happens in private channels your analytics will never see.

That recommendation is the whole game. You are either the name in the bubble, or you are invisible.

DARK SOCIAL

Your customer is talking right now. You're not in the room.

Private Slack
Not indexed

WhatsApp threads
Not indexed

Email forwards
Not indexed

Your paid ads
Never reaches

The only thing that reaches that room is trust. Built over months of someone reading your thinking, watching you be specific and right about their problem.

III

Earn. Concentrate. Compound.

Three moves, in the right order, that build the kind of attention that puts you on the day-one list.

01

Earn it

through specificity, not volume

WRONG DIRECTION

Post more.

Advertise more broadly.

Reach more people.

Blast further.

RIGHT DIRECTION

Reach the right people so specifically they feel you wrote it just for them.

PROOF

Lenny Rachitsky wrote for **one person**, a single PM at a growth-stage startup, so deeply it spoke to thousands like them.

500K

readers · $2M/yr

PROOF · HUBSPOT

Specificity at scale becomes a category.

248K
CUSTOMERS

135
COUNTRIES

$2.6B
REVENUE

They wrote about the exact, in-the-weeds problems marketers faced, long before they had the revenue. The audience came first. The category followed.

02

Concentrate

be somewhere before you try to be everywhere

MOST FOUNDERS

LinkedIn · thin, generic content
X / Twitter · thin, generic content
YouTube · thin, generic content
Newsletter · thin, generic content
Podcast · thin, generic content

BUILDERS WHO WIN

Pick one channel.

The one where their specific customer actually lives.

Go deep before going wide.

Rand Fishkin $500K in debt → Moz, $50M ARR

Gong LinkedIn only → hundreds of millions

Fireflies one honest post → $1B

PROOF · FIREFLIES.AI

One post. One channel. A billion-dollar company.



~3K reactions in days

Viral across Slack + WhatsApp

$1B valuation today

Brutally honest. One channel. Specificity built in.

03 Compound

design the flywheel before you need it

Specific content → **The right people** trust you → **Customers** talk about you → **More right people** find you

Each turn makes the next one easier. That is compounding attention.

Canva 10M users across 179 countries, sharing built into the product. **Figma** beat Sketch by making collaboration free. It spread through trust networks.

THE FRAMEWORK, IN ONE VIEW

Earn. Concentrate. Compound.

01

EARN

Specificity over volume

Reach the right people so accurately they feel you wrote it for them.

02

CONCENTRATE

Depth before width

One channel, where your customer lives. Go deep before you go wide.

03

COMPOUND

Design the flywheel

Make sharing effortless. Give people language and results worth spreading.

THE TAKEAWAY

The technology is no longer the differentiator.

Being in the right person's head, specifically, accurately, credibly, before they ever know they need you.

That is the only moat left standing.

IF THIS LANDED

Let's keep the conversation going.

